



section. It was the Question of the month. You should be able to get your answer. You might need to integrate your hard drive controller drives if the laptop is really new and the drivers aren't available on XP's installation CD. The problem with drivers usually happens with the SATA controller and you'll notice it the moment you boot into the XP CD. Your drives will not be detected in case that happens. You can use software called Nlite (www.nliteos.com) to do this.

Display Gone Dead After Bootup

Q My system configuration is as follows: Motherboard: Intel D945GCCR, Processor: 1.8GHz Dual Core, Ram: Dynate 2 GB, Power Supply: PSTECH 450 W, Hard Disk: Seagate 160 GB, Optical Drive: Sony DVD Rw, Operating System: Vista Ulitmate Edition, Monitor: Acer LCD 17-inch Model No. AL1716

My problem is that until today morning my system was running perfectly but after two hours the system automatically restarted. Now it takes a lot of time to load Vista. I manually restarted the system. When i start the computer now, the monitor does not display anything but the fans in the cabinet are working. I've tried everything like removing the battery, changing the RAM and even the power supply and monitor. But it can't display anything.

A The problem could be with a couple of things — mostly your hard drive and the power supply. The slowdown could be explained by some issues with the drive. If there is a display when you first power up your PC, then it is to do with the power supply. If the display doesn't come on when you turn on your PC, then a power supply could be to blame. Listen for any beeps as well. If there are any beeps, refer to your motherboard manual to try and pinpoint to what the problem could be.

I Think My Drive Failed

Q My system's DVD combo drive has a problem. Whenever I load a CD or DVD into the drive system hangs up and after sometime a message appears that there is no disk in the drive. When I insert a CD-R into the drive, it is detected but when I burn the CD with Nero, an error message appears during the burn process and disk becomes useless. Please help me.

I have an option to go for a DVD writer if the problem cannot be fixed. I have only IDE ports on the motherboard. I would like to buy a Lite-on DVD writer. I am from Kerala. Where can I buy one?

Akhil S Nath

A You might have a faulty drive. IDE drives are easily available are priced between Rs 1,100 and Rs 1,200. The LH-201A1P is a good model. If you have problems finding it, you can

also look at other brands such as LG. The LG GSA-H55 is another good drive.

Virus problems with Windows 98

Q I use Windows 98 and I installed a trial version of Quick Heal and Norton GoBack. The antivirus software I have does not provide me with a native boot scan facility on start up. When I start my PC it shows the wallpaper but the other icons and the startup toolbars do not appear. Every time to start my PC, I have to revert with the help of Norton GoBack.

When I scan my computer, it shows seven scan warnings. I have tried to remove the antivirus software to reinstall but when I restart my PC the same problem appears. I have to again revert to all the previous settings over and over again. Please guide on my how I can remove the viruses stored in boot sector or repair system. I have lots of data on my PC. The virus has also infected a lot of the Windows system files. Please help. Thanks and regards

Shrinivas

A You firstly need to try and update your anti-virus with the latest updates so that the application can try and clean the viruses. If the antivirus comes with a bootable disk option, make one and try boot into a floppy or a CD and clean your drive with it. This is the best way to fix any boot sector viruses that you might have. You can also try connecting your hard drive to another computer if that has an antivirus installed. Scan your drive through the other computer with the antivirus. If no antivirus can clean your drive, then you should also back up all of your essential data on to the other drive as the virus might have done irreversible damage to the operating system. You will then need to format your drive and reinstall Windows.

Drive At The End Of Its Life?

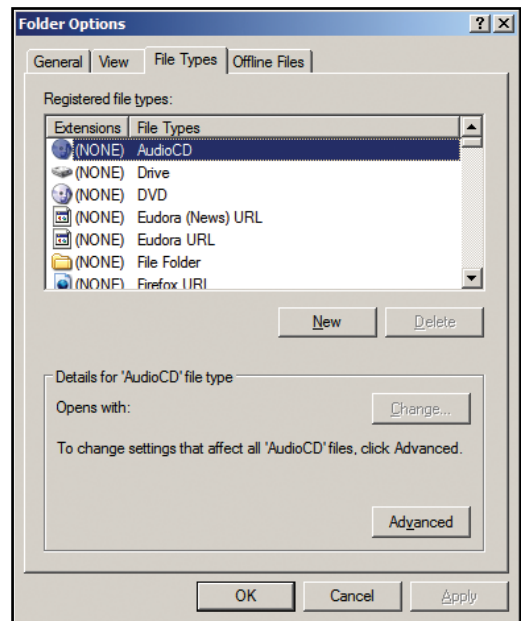
Q I own an 80 GB SAMSUNG SP0802N hard disk. Lately, I have installed two software - HDD life Pro 2.5.62 and Hard Dive Inspector 1.85 build #950. When I run both the software, they show some extreme messages. One of them says that the drive has no problem and the other says it is close to failing. Is it time to backup my data?

Chikku George Thomas

A Your Samsung SP0802N 80 GB drive is now close to ancient and it's definitely served well when many drives fail within a year or two at times. Both the software might be measuring the state of the drive through different methods, and that's why you are getting the contradictory messages. A drive this old could fail any moment, so it's wise to create a backup of your vital data on another drive or on DVDs to be safe.☐

Nero Handles All My Executables!

Q I have Windows Vista Ultimate running on my computer but unknowingly I went and executed an executable file with Nero Backitup with the option ticked to run all programs with Nero backup. Now, every executable file in Vista starts with Nero so then I removed it and thought that the problems would undo itself but now none of the programs are working.



Explorer Folder Options can be used to fix file handling issues

A You can solve it with following steps:

1. Go to My Computer
2. Click on Tools in the menu bar
3. Click on Folder options
4. Click on the File Types tab
5. In Registered file types, select extension EXE.
- Look at the type of associated program and see that it is Nero Backitup.
6. Select extension and click on delete.
7. Restart your computer

Jagdeep Virdi (TECH QNA Expert)

DEP Errors With Windows XP2

Q I get a computer data execution error message popup when I click on any file, I want to disable it. Please help me.

A If you have XP SP2, then it may be "Data Execution Prevention" (DEP) error. Turn off DEP in the XP Control Panel

1. Click the Start button at the bottom left of your screen
2. Click the Control Panel menu item
3. Then, double-click the System icon.
4. Click the Advanced tab
5. Find the item marked Performance right under there is a button that says Settings.



6. Click the Data Execution Prevention tab.
7. You will see two options in that window. Click the second option that says "Turn on DEP for all programs and services except those I select."
8. When you are finished with that then click the 'Add...' button it should be visable at the bottom of the box. Then, you have to find where the file 'explorer.exe' resides on your computer most of the time it's something like this C:\WINDOWS\EXPLORER.EXE anyway add explorer to that list. It'll give you a warning just ignore it and click OK. Then, you reboot and if you try it everything should work just fine.

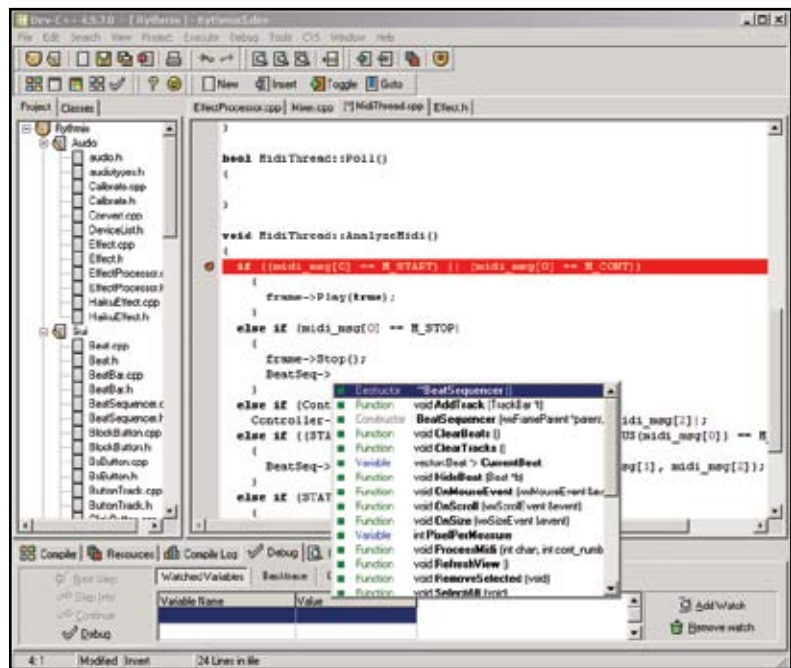
Jagdeep Virdi (TECH QNA Expert)

Turbo C Crashes On Vista

Q My problem is that I am not able to do any graphical programming through my Vista operating system. Firstly, it does not support full screen and secondly when I run any program in the small Turbo C screen, it shows error NTVDM.exe and stops working. The screen flickers and goes blank. Is there any way to fix this? I use Turbo C and Windows Vista Home Basic.

A Try using the Dev CPP IDE and this should help fix your problem. It is an updated application with a host of additional features. It also uses the gcc compiler. The turbo c compiler has not been updated and support for it is not available. Dev CPP is a free compiler available online. I have not tried Turbo C in Vista.

Prasanth Philip (TECH QNA Expert)



Dev CPP is a great free IDE for C and CPP programming